We asked an AI for 10,198 gift ideas

3,400 made-up shoppers, three gift picks each. The Gift Whisperer, November 11, 2026.

The Gift Whisperer is a small gift recommendation site in Austin, Texas. To see what its AI recommender does across thousands of questions instead of one, founder Daniel Maghini made up 3,400 shoppers from the answers the recommender asks for (who the gift is for, age, occasion, interests, budget, things or experiences) and ran every one through it.

KEY NUMBERS

- 2,576 different products and 1,164 different experiences across 10,198 picks.
- The same gifts repeat: the Kindle Paperwhite was 3.2% of all product picks, and 43% of shoppers who like reading got a Kindle product. A wine tasting tour was 6.6% of experience picks; the ten most common experiences made up 31% of them.
- 43.0% of picks were experiences. Shoppers who said they like both got experiences 30.8% of the time. When told "things only" or "experiences only," the AI never broke the rule.
- Personalized gifts were 28% of product picks for partners, 16% for colleagues and 36% for anniversaries.
- Budgets held up to $100. At "$250 or more," about 1 in 5 picks (21.5%) cost less than $250.
- Nothing alcohol-related went to anyone under 18 apart from two mocktail classes.
- About 1 in 9 product names (10.8% estimated) did not match a listing exactly as written; 0.8% of the names checked had nothing close.

METHOD IN BRIEF

3,400 unique shoppers generated with a fixed random seed from the recommender's own options. One request each on November 11, 2026, using the same instructions and AI model as the live recommender. The top three picks per shopper were analyzed. Product names were checked by a second AI model with web search: all 644 brand and model names plus a random 200 of the other 1,932. Full method on the page.

LIMITS

Made-up shoppers, not real ones: this describes the AI, not what people want or buy. One AI model on one day. No purchases were made. Name checks depend on web search and an AI judge, so treat them as estimates.

DATA

A CSV of every pick is on the page. Free to quote, chart and cite with a link back; please don't republish the full file.

Full page, method and data: https://thegiftwhisperer.gifts/research/ai-gift-recommendations
Contact: https://www.thegiftwhisperer.gifts/contact · Daniel Maghini, Founder, The Gift Whisperer